Ivy Sarah Mae Berowa Arimao

Dr. Ivy Sarah Mae Berowa Arimao, RSW is a Filipino social worker, educator, and public administration scholar based at Mindanao State University (MSU) in Marawi City. She currently serves as Professor VI in the Department of Public Administration, College of Public Affairs, a permanent post she has held since October 2024, and she also carries the title of Special Assistant to the Office of the Vice President for Academic Affairs within the MSU System.

Born on April 1, 1985 in Marawi City, Ivy grew up in the Dimaluna area near the MSU campus, where she still resides today. She is married to Jehanoddin Carim Arimao, an administrative employee at MSU, and the couple has four children. Her father, the late **Pasayod Patarandang Berowa**, and her mother, **Alma Eliot Elape**, raised her in Marawi City before she went on to build a career that stretched from frontline social work to the halls of academia.

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Early Life and Education

Ivy studied elementary education at the Integrated Laboratory School in Marawi City, graduating in 1998 as a Bronze Medalist. She completed secondary school at the Science Training Center/ICNHS in 2002, before enrolling at Mindanao State University for her Bachelor of Science in Social Work, which she completed in 2006.

She went on to earn her Master in Public Administration at MSU in 2018, then her Doctor of Public Administration in 2023, both from the same university where she now teaches. She holds a Professional Regulation Commission license as a Registered Social Worker (RSW) under RA 1080, having passed the licensure examination in Cagayan de Oro City in June 2006.

Dr. Ivy Sarah Mae Berowa Arimao, RSW



Born
April 1, 1985, Marawi City

Nationality
Filipino

Spouse
Jehanoddin Carim Arimao

Occupation
Professor VI, Public Administration; Registered Social Worker

Education
Doctor of Public Administration (2023), Master in Public Administration (2018), BS Social Work (2006), all from Mindanao State University, Marawi City

Institution
Mindanao State University (MSU), Marawi City

Notability
A career social worker turned public administration scholar whose fieldwork during evacuation operations, gender-based violence programs, and conditional cash transfer implementation across Mindanao shaped decades of grassroots governance research.

Known For
Bridging community-level social work with academic public administration, and representing Philippine governance

Early Career and Field Work

Ivy's first professional role came in August 2006, when she worked as a Community Organizer for the Community Empowerment Program in Balindong, Lanao del Sur, a project of the Davao Medical School Foundation's Institute of Primary Health Care in partnership with the Japan International Cooperation Agency. From January 2007 to February 2008, she served as Municipal Facilitator for the ARMM Social Fund Project under the Department of Social Welfare and Development, ARMM.

Her work then took her to Agusan del Sur, where from January to December 2010 she served as Project Development Officer IV for a special project against gender-based violence under DSWD CARAGA. She followed this with two years as City Link/Team Leader for the Pantawid Pamilyang Pilipino Program in Iligan City (December 2010 to August 2012), then two more years as Cluster Grievance Redress System Officer for the same program in Lanao del Sur (August 2012 to November 2014).

In between these postings, she took on short-term assignments that reflected her willingness to respond wherever she was needed, including a stint as Camp Manager at a DSWD evacuation center in Pala-o, Iligan City in late 2011, and a brief posting as Field Supervisor for a gender, peace, and security project under the Office of the Presidential Adviser on the Peace Process in October 2010.

Academic Career

Ivy's move into teaching began in September 2008, when she joined Iligan Medical Center College as an Instructor in the Social Work Department. In November 2014, she transitioned into MSU's academic ranks as Assistant Professor I at the College of Social Sciences and Humanities, first on a contractual basis and later, from 2016 to 2019, as a probationary appointee.

By August 2019 she had moved to the College of Public Affairs as Associate Professor V, this time on a permanent appointment, and in October 2024 she was promoted to Professor VI, the rank she holds today. In April and May of that year, she also served as Exchange Faculty at ISCTE, the Instituto Universitario de Lisboa in Portugal, under the Erasmus+ Mobility Program, bringing Mindanao's governance experience into conversation with European academic circles.

Research and International Engagement

Much of Ivy's scholarship centers on the Conditional Cash Transfer (CCT) Program and its implementation challenges in Balindong, Lanao del Sur, a subject she carried into international academic spaces. Her paper on this topic was presented at the 3rd International Social Development Conference in Kedah, Malaysia in 2018, and later published in the International Journal of Advanced Science and Technology in 2020.

She has also brought her research on governance during the COVID-19 pandemic to conferences in Indonesia and Nepal, including the International Conference India and Southeast Asia (ICISA) in Makassar in 2021 and the EROPA Virtual Conference in 2022, where she spoke on Philippine government responses to the pandemic and their implications for policy. As a speaker, she has covered topics ranging from generalist social work practice to leadership in the BARMM government context, often lecturing to graduate students and civic groups at MSU's College of Public Affairs.

scholarship at international conferences across Asia and Europe.

Pull Quote

"From the evacuation centers of Iligan to the lecture halls of Lisbon, her work never strayed far from the people it was meant to serve."

Professional Affiliations and Civic Involvement

Ivy holds memberships in several professional and alumni organizations, including the Philippine Society for Public Administration (PSPA), the Philippine Association of Social Workers Incorporated (PASWI), the JSPS Alumni Association of the Philippines, the MSU Alumni Association, and Alpha Phi Omega. She has also completed numerous learning and development programs over the years, covering outcomes-based education, records management, curriculum development, and disaster and pandemic response, among other topics.

Her technical skill set spans teaching, counseling, project management, facilitating, training needs assessment, gender and development work, computer literacy, process documentation, case study writing, and community organizing.

See Also

- Mindanao State University
- College of Public Affairs, MSU
- Department of Social Welfare and Development
- Pantawid Pamilyang Pilipino Program

References

- Curriculum Vitae of Dr. Ivy Sarah Mae Berowa-Arimao, submitted by the subject, 2026.
- Personal Data Sheet (CS Form No. 212, Revised 2025) of Ivy Sarah Mae Berowa Arimao, submitted by the subject, March 2026.

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